Tornado Tigers · Practice 10 · Defense

Tue Jan 19 · 5:30-6:30 pm · Rockwell Elementary · Coaches Brett and Cameron

Before 5:30: Coaches arrive 5:20: pump balls, poly spots out, lower hoops to 8 ft if they crank, water bottles along one wall, same two groups of 4 (Brett and Cameron).

- [ ] **5:30** **Opening huddle**
  Kids in a half circle. Today's goal: stay between your player and our basket. Remind: whistle means stop and hold the ball.
  Say: Here's what we're getting better at today
  Coaches: one leads, one keeps everyone listening

- [ ] **5:32** **Warm-up: Roll-em > sprint and slide**
  As before.
  Say: Low and wide
  Coaches: one calls it, one at the far end

- [ ] **5:40** **Rule of the week: pick-up line and defense**
  Guard your player after they cross the pick-up line. Stay between them and our basket. No reaching.
  Say: Wait at the line, then guard
  Coaches: one explains, one demonstrates

- [ ] **5:42** **Skill 1: Defensive stance + mirror**
  Partners face each other; offense steps side to side, defense mirrors in stance.
  Say: Stay in front like a shadow
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **5:49** **Water**
  Balls on spots, walk to bottles.
  Coaches: one runs it, one sets up the next drill

- [ ] **5:51** **Skill 2: Home base**
  After a coach's shot, sprint back, find your wristband color, get in stance.
  Say: Run back, find your color
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **5:58** **Skill 3: Numbers game with defense**
  Coach calls a number: one player goes on offense, partner defends, one basket.
  Say: Hands up, feet moving
  Coaches: demo together, then one coach per group

- [ ] **6:05** **Water + rules check**
  Pinnies on. Before we play, players say the rules back: quick quiz, coach starts and players finish: no stealing from a...(dribbler); hands straight up, no...(swatting); no pushing or...(holding); wait at the...(pick-up line); guard your...(color); after the game we...(high-five).
  Say: Tell me the rules before we play
  Coaches: one runs it, one sets up the next drill

- [ ] **6:07** **Scrimmage: defense focus**
  Normal 4v4 with the pick-up line marked. Coaches freeze play to check defensive position.
  Say: Between your player and our basket
  Coaches: one refs, one coaches

- [ ] **6:16** **Closing huddle**
  Did we hit today's goal? Thumbs up. Ask one or two kids what they liked. Try at home: slide races down the hallway, no crossing feet. Team cheer.
  Say: Then raise hoops, sweep, hand off to parents
  Coaches: one leads, one keeps everyone listening